



Carpenter

carpenter • 3-4 year apprenticeship

\$45K-\$65K / yr

THE TRADE

Build, frame, and finish the wood structures behind every project — from rough framing to custom millwork. The most accessible of the building trades, with a 3-4 year apprenticeship that pays from week one and endless on-the-job variety.

SALARY & TRAINING

JOURNEYMAN BAND (SITE FIGURE — SAME AS QUIZ RESULT & TRADES PAGE)

\$45K-\$65K

BLS median \$51,390 (blog-cited) • apprentice 3-4 yr, ~4,800 OJT hrs (UBC)
• foremen reach \$60K-\$80K+

THE PATH: FROM RESEARCH TO HIRED

01 RESEARCH Compare training routes, union vs non-union, and local demand

02 TRAIN Trade school / pre-apprenticeship — start with OSHA 10

03 HANDS-ON Apprentice years: log hours, earn raises to 80-90% of scale

04 CERTIFIED Pass the journeyman or industry certification exam

05 HIRED Journey-level pay — specialize, stack certs, own the shop

Every apprentice track pays from day one — typical start is 40-50% of journey scale with scheduled raises every year. Each step above is fully mapped on the TradeLift Getting Started guide and the site's resources page.



REQUIRED CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

OSHA 10 Hour — required on almost every site

YOUR FIRST 12 WEEKS — THE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Take the TradeLift quiz to confirm if you earn your OSHA 10 online
- ☐ Get First Aid/CPR certified
- ☐ Draft a one-page trade resume
- ☐ Call the local UBC carpenters' hall
- ☐ Search apprenticeship.gov carpentry
- ☐ Buy a hammer, tape measure, speed square
- ☐ Practice reading a tape measure cold
- ☐ Build one small project (photo proof)
- ☐ Apply to 3 carpenter apprenticeships
- ☐ Prep the math and reading intake test
- ☐ Volunteer one day on a build site

Full career steps, certifications, and tool guides: <https://tradelift.surge.sh/getting-started.html>